

6 Android/OpenMoko

wiki/Neo_FreeRunner_Hardware.

The above listed specs are for the second release of the project called the “Neo FreeRunner”, the previous one was called the “Neo 1973”.

Now we turn our attention a bit towards the software stack available for this phone.

The official distribution available for the phone is the “Om Series”. Currently, the latest version is the Om 2009 which is under the testing5 stage right now (was last updated on June 16, 2009 at the time of writing this article) and it already supports most of the features needed by end-users of a mobile such as SMS, calling, phone book, call log, charging, suspend and resume, Wi-Fi GUI, audio profiles and more.

But what is the fun in using the official especially when given that this an open-phone making it the most fertile hacker’s playground. There are more than 10 community developed distributions available for this phone. If it is any pointer towards the capability of the phone, you can install and run the whole “Debian” on your phone, and nearly use all of the packages also (which tend to infinity). This is also supported by the debian community. As a good starting point you can visit the following link <http://wiki.debian.org/DebianOnFreeRunner>.

Android Project is also fully supporting the OpenMoko initiative and already it is possible to run the Android OS on the OpenMoko which is sufficiently capable of daily phone usage needs. In the long run, Android looks such as a strong contender to become the default OS for this Phone. Open hardware plus open software is match made in heaven.

Unlike most bleeding edge technology, this phone is available in India also via IDA systems, one of the official distributors for the phone (<http://www.idasystems.net/>). At Rs. 24,000, it is definitely not cheap, but given the hardware specification and the potential software eco system it may well be worth every penny it asks for.



GPS capabilities of a OpenMoko Phone